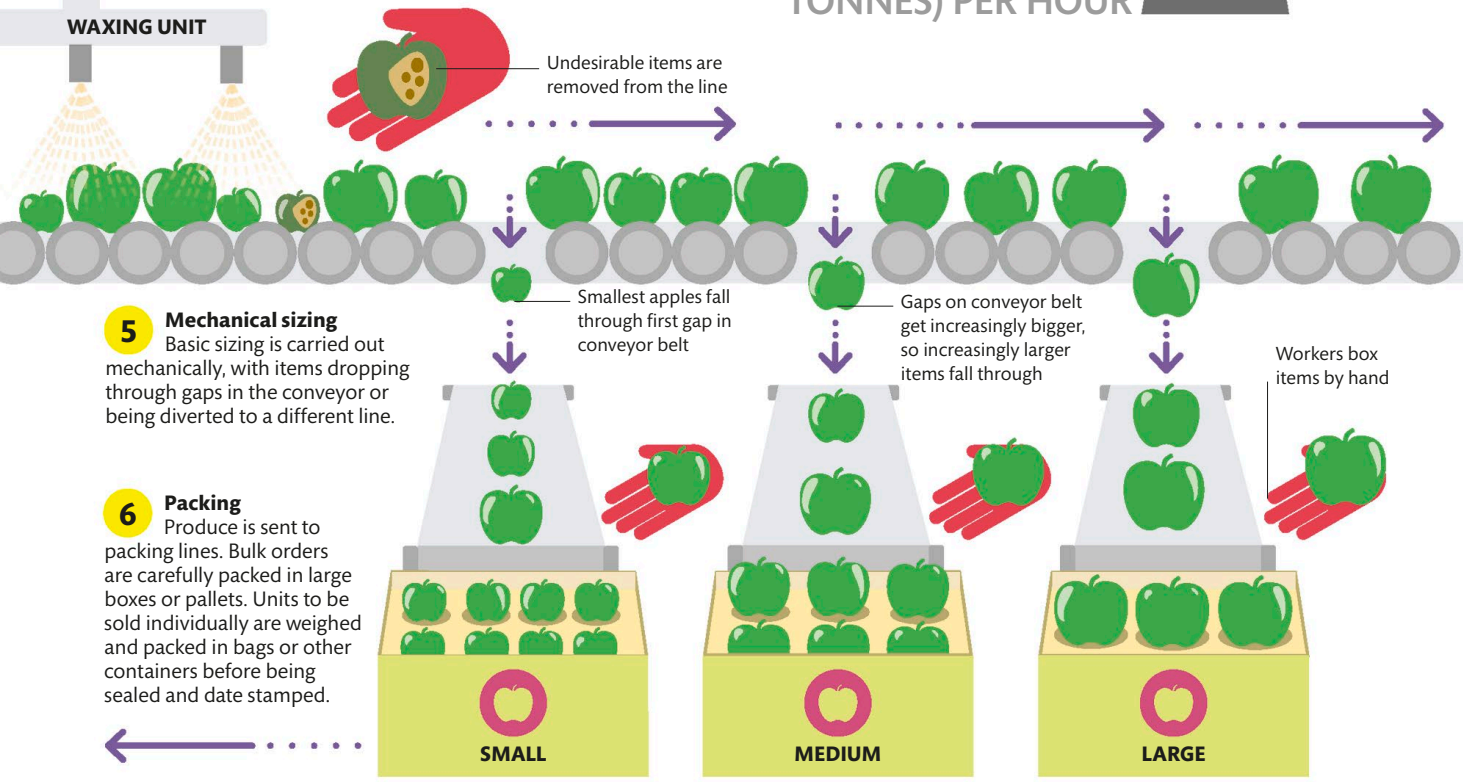
3 Waxing
Waxing replaces natural waxes on fruits that are lost in washing. Produce may also be dipped in a fungicide or irradiated to reduce organism growth.

4 Hand sorting
Damaged or diseased fruits are picked out by experienced workers, who also remove underripe and misshapen items.

OPTICAL SORTERS CAN PROCESS UP TO **38 TONS** (35 TONNES) PER HOUR



5 Mechanical sizing
Basic sizing is carried out mechanically, with items dropping through gaps in the conveyor or being diverted to a different line.

6 Packing
Produce is sent to packing lines. Bulk orders are carefully packed in large boxes or pallets. Units to be sold individually are weighed and packed in bags or other containers before being sealed and date stamped.

WHEN WERE CARDBOARD BOXES FIRST USED FOR PACKAGING?

Cardboard was invented in 1856, but it was not until 1903 that it was first formed into boxes and used for packing.

MODIFIED ATMOSPHERE PACKAGING

Some fruits and vegetables have high respiration rates or give off ripening gases that decrease their shelf life. Changing the atmosphere inside the package can slow this down. Vacuum packing removes air, which helps reduce enzyme reactions and bacterial growth. Gas flushing replaces air with a modified gas mixture that prevents spoilage. Permeable bagging materials can be used to allow gases created by produce to diffuse out and equalize with ambient levels.

